

USE OF AI IN HYPERACTIVE SOCIAL MEDIA ADVERTISEMENTS & ITS EFFECTS ON BRAND PERCEPTION AND CONSUMER RESPONSE



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IAPC - PROJECT
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Certificate of Originality

This is to certify that the work embodied in this report entitled "Use of AI in Hyperactive Social Media Advertisements and Its Effects on Brand Perception and Consumer Response" has been carried out by Abhimanyu Nain, Abu Obaidha Arin, Ratika Rajput and Sajal Samveg as part of IAPC project in Semester VI of the B.Tech programme at Cluster Innovation Centre, University of Delhi, under the guidance of Dr. Sanjeewni Sehgal.

We hereby declare that the contents of this project report are the result of our own original research and efforts. The report is free from any form of plagiarism, and all sources of information and references have been duly acknowledged in accordance with standard academic practice.

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Abstract

The proliferation of artificial intelligence in social media advertising has ushered in an era of hyperactive, algorithmically personalised content delivery, wherein brand messages pursue consumers across platforms at unprecedented speed and frequency. While this technological evolution offers marketers granular targeting capabilities, it simultaneously introduces a set of under-examined psychological stressors — most notably Algorithmic Paranoia, the unsettling perception that one is under continuous commercial surveillance, and Information Fatigue, the cognitive exhaustion arising from incessant exposure to curated promotional content. These phenomena exist in dialectical tension with the concept of Algorithmic Serendipity, wherein a precisely timed, contextually relevant advertisement generates a positive, discovery-like response in the consumer.

This study investigates the dual nature of AI-driven hyperactive social media advertising and its effects on two primary downstream outcomes: (1) brand perception, encompassing consumer trust, brand authenticity, and overall brand attitude; and (2) consumer response behaviours, including ad-avoidance tendencies, purchase intention, and performative sharing — the practice of disseminating brand content as a mechanism for identity signalling and peer approval. A third strand of inquiry examines the role of "Meme-jacking" — the strategic co-optation of viral cultural artefacts by brands — as a distinct communicative tactic and its attendant effects on perceived brand authenticity.

A quantitative cross-sectional survey methodology was adopted for data collection. A structured questionnaire, informed by established measurement scales drawn from the extant literature on advertising value (Ducoffe, 1996), ad-avoidance behaviour (Cho & Cheon, 2004), and brand relationship quality (Kim et al., 2015), was administered to a purposive sample of social media users. Data collection is complete, and the dataset is currently undergoing statistical analysis using Structural Equation Modelling (SEM) via SPSS and AMOS. Empirical results, including the testing of six directional hypotheses organised across two primary research questions, are forthcoming.

This study contributes to the intersection of computational advertising, consumer psychology, and brand management by providing a theoretically grounded empirical framework for understanding how algorithmic intelligence shapes — and in some instances distorts — the consumer-brand relationship in the hyper-mediated digital environment.

1. Introduction & Problem Statement

1.1 Background

The last decade has witnessed a structural transformation in the commercial logic of social media platforms. Platforms such as Instagram, TikTok, YouTube Shorts, and Meta's content ecosystem no longer function merely as conduits for organic social interaction; they operate as algorithmically optimised attention markets, wherein user data is harvested in real time to serve advertising content calibrated to individual psychological profiles. The deployment of machine learning models — including collaborative filtering, reinforcement learning-based recommendation engines, and large-language-model-driven creative optimisation — has elevated both the precision and the volume of advertising exposure to levels previously unattainable in the history of mass communication (Ghenie et al., 2025).

This paradigm shift has produced a dual consequence. On the one hand, advertisers have gained access to granular behavioural signals — browsing patterns, dwell time, affective responses to content, and cross-platform identity graphs — enabling the construction of what practitioners term "hyperactive" advertising ecosystems: environments in which brand messages follow the consumer seamlessly across contexts, time zones, and device types. On the other hand, the consumer subject occupying this environment experiences an advertising landscape that is simultaneously omnipresent and uncanny. The personalisation is sufficiently precise to feel, at times, like surveillance rather than service — a phenomenon that scholars have begun to theorise under the rubric of Algorithmic Paranoia (Alavi, Iyer, & Bright, 2024).

It is within this context that the present study situates itself. The emergence of short-form video as the dominant advertising format — characterised by autoplay mechanics, full-screen immersive display, and rapid content cycling — represents the operational apex of the hyperactive advertising ecosystem. Platforms designed around short-form video have demonstrated that the Stimulus-Organism-Response (S-O-R) framework, long applied to physical retail environments, operates with equivalent explanatory power in the digital space: video attributes such as informativeness, entertainment, and incentivisation produce affective and cognitive organism-level responses — most prominently flow experience and trust — which in turn govern behavioural outcomes such as purchase intention and word-of-mouth dissemination (Ghenie et al., 2025).

1.2 Problem Statement

Despite a growing body of research on digital advertising effectiveness, several critical gaps remain unaddressed in the extant literature. First, the majority of prior studies examine advertising exposure as a unidirectional stimulus, neglecting the reciprocal dynamic whereby consumers actively construe, resist, and recontextualise algorithmic content curation (Alavi et al., 2024). The psychological mechanisms through which repeated, personalised exposure transitions from generating positive surprise — conceptualised herein as Algorithmic Serendipity — to inducing cognitive fatigue and active avoidance remain empirically under-examined.

Second, the literature on brand perception in algorithmically mediated environments has not adequately addressed the authenticity paradox: the situation in which a brand's deployment of AI-driven personalisation may simultaneously increase ad relevance and decrease perceived brand sincerity. Tactics such as Meme-jacking — wherein brands co-opt viral, user-generated cultural artefacts for promotional purposes — have received limited scholarly attention despite their widespread adoption in digital marketing practice. The boundary conditions under which such tactics enhance versus erode brand authenticity perceptions constitute a meaningful research gap.

Third, existing frameworks for consumer sharing behaviour in social media advertising contexts have been insufficiently attentive to the distinction between genuine brand advocacy and Performative Sharing — the strategic dissemination of advertising content as a form of identity construction or peer-approval seeking. As social media advertising blurs the boundary between organic and paid content, understanding the motivational architecture of sharing behaviour becomes critical for both academic theory and practitioner strategy.

Current research faces three principal limitations that this study seeks to address:

1. Theoretical fragmentation: Studies examining ad-avoidance, brand perception, and sharing behaviour typically operate in isolation, precluding the development of an integrated model of algorithmic advertising effects.
2. Construct specificity: Constructs such as Algorithmic Paranoia, Serendipity Buffer, and Meme-jacking are emerging phenomena that lack validated measurement instruments in the social media advertising context.
3. Contextual gap: The majority of prior empirical work draws on Western consumer samples, leaving the attitudinal and behavioural responses of consumers in rapidly digitising economies — such as India — theoretically unaddressed.

1.3 Scope and Significance

This study focuses on the social media advertising behaviour and attitudinal responses of adult consumers (18–35 years) in India — a demographic that constitutes one of the world's largest and fastest-growing digitally connected consumer populations, and for whom short-form video

has become the primary interface with both entertainment and commercial content. By sampling within this context, the study extends the generalisability of prevailing Western-centric theories of digital advertising avoidance and brand relationship quality.

The significance of this work is threefold. For academic theory, it proposes and empirically tests an integrative framework connecting algorithmic advertising stimuli to brand perception outcomes, mediated by affective and cognitive consumer states. For practitioner strategy, the findings offer actionable guidance on the design of AI-driven advertising campaigns that balance personalisation depth with psychological safety — reducing the risk of consumer reactance. For policy, the study contributes evidence relevant to ongoing regulatory discussions concerning algorithmic transparency and the ethics of behavioural targeting.

1.4 Research Questions

The present study is guided by two primary research questions and hypothesis:

RQ1: How do AI-driven hyperactive social media advertisements influence consumer brand perception, with specific reference to brand trust, perceived brand authenticity, and overall brand attitude?

- H1a (Stressor Effect): Algorithmic Paranoia and Information Fatigue are positive predictors of Ad-Avoidance Behaviour.
- H1b (Serendipity Buffer): Algorithmic Serendipity is a negative predictor of Ad-Avoidance Behaviour, suggesting that high perceived relevance and timing can mitigate the desire to skip block ads.
- H1c (Moderation Effect): Algorithmic Serendipity significantly moderates the relationship between Algorithmic Paranoia and Ad-Avoidance; specifically, the positive impact of paranoia on avoidance will be weaker when serendipity is high.

RQ2: How do AI-driven hyperactive social media advertisements influence consumer response behaviours — specifically ad-avoidance tendencies, purchase intention, and performative sharing — and to what extent does Algorithmic Serendipity moderate these relationships?

- H2a (Meme-jacking Outcome): Meme-jacking in advertisements is a positive predictor of Performative Sharing, as consumers use trending formats to signal identity to their social network.

- H2b (Ephemerality Urgency): Message Ephemerality is a positive predictor of full ad-viewing behaviour and a negative predictor of Ad-Avoidance due to the perceived urgency and limited-time nature of the content.
- H2c (The Identity Link): There is a positive correlation between an ad's trend-based nature (Meme-jacking) and a consumer's motivation for Performative Sharing, driven by the desire for peer perception and identity signalling.

These questions are operationalised through a series of directional hypotheses presented in the Research Methodology section. The theoretical framework structuring the study positions AI-driven advertising hyperactivity as the primary independent construct, with Algorithmic Serendipity serving as a moderating variable and Algorithmic Paranoia as a mediating psychological mechanism.

2. Literature Review

The following review synthesises the relevant theoretical and empirical scholarship organised thematically. Rather than proceeding author-by-author, the review groups findings according to the three thematic pillars underpinning the present study: (1) the evolution of digital ad-avoidance from early banner blindness to algorithmic-era paranoia; (2) the mechanics of short-form, hyperactive video advertising and its effects on consumer engagement; and (3) the psychology of performative sharing and its implications for brand relationship quality.

2.1 The Evolution of Digital Ad-Avoidance: From Banner Blindness to Algorithmic Paranoia

The scholarly investigation of advertising avoidance in digital media traces its origins to early work on "banner blindness" — the selective inattention to peripheral display advertisements in web environments — and was formalised conceptually by Cho and Cheon (2004), whose tripartite model identified prior negative advertising experiences, perceived goal impediment, and perceived clutter as the primary antecedents of avoidance behaviour across cognitive, affective, and behavioural dimensions. This foundational model established the central premise that advertising avoidance is not a passive failure of attention but an active, purposive response to perceived intrusion.

The transition from static web display advertising to algorithmically curated social media advertising introduced new theoretical complexity. Alavi, Iyer, and Bright (2024) advanced the literature significantly by situating avoidance behaviour within the specific dynamics of algorithmic media. Their research demonstrates that social media fatigue — a cumulative depletion of cognitive and emotional resources resulting from continuous, algorithm-driven content consumption — operates as a critical mediating mechanism between algorithmic content exposure and ad-avoidance behaviour. Crucially, their framework also identifies algorithmic literacy — the degree to which a consumer understands the logic and data inputs governing content curation — as a variable that amplifies rather than attenuates avoidance, as greater awareness of being profiled heightens privacy concerns and perceived surveillance.

This latter finding aligns with a growing stream of scholarship on what the present study terms Algorithmic Paranoia: the consumer's experiential state of hypervigilance regarding the data collection, profiling, and behavioural prediction underpinning personalised advertising delivery. Unlike the more general concept of privacy concern, which is dispositional and attitudinal, Algorithmic Paranoia is situationally activated by specific advertising encounters that feel uncanny in their precision — colloquially described by consumers as "my phone is listening to me." An investigation of marketing problems across service sectors (Journal of Services Marketing, 2003) noted early that the erosion of consumer trust through perceived commercial manipulation was among the most persistent challenges facing service marketers — a challenge that has only intensified with the opacity of algorithmic targeting systems.

Complementary work on ad overload perception confirms that ad clutter and intrusiveness significantly influence users' perceptions of goal impediment and social media fatigue, both of which independently and cumulatively increase avoidance tendencies (Researchgate, 2025). The application of reactance theory and cognitive load theory to this literature reveals that algorithmically hyperactive advertising environments — characterised by high frequency, high relevance, and high visual density — exceed the psychological threshold at which personalisation is experienced as beneficial, triggering reactance-based avoidance. Furthermore, research on brand-driven social media fatigue demonstrates that when advertising is perceived as intrusive, it contributes not only to avoidance of the specific advertisement but to broader disengagement from the brand (Emerald, 2024), establishing a direct pathway from algorithmic advertising characteristics to brand perception outcomes.

The concept of Algorithmic Serendipity, introduced in this study as a theoretically distinct counterweight to Algorithmic Paranoia, draws on Mendelberg's (2012) discussion of

serendipitous discovery in information-seeking contexts and extends it to the advertising domain. A serendipitous ad encounter is one in which the consumer perceives the algorithm's suggestion as a welcome, discovery-like experience — a recommendation that aligns not merely with stated preferences but with latent desires. The moderating effect of Algorithmic Serendipity on the relationship between hyperactive advertising exposure and consumer response behaviour constitutes a central hypothesis of the present study and represents a novel contribution to the extant literature.

2.2 Hyperactive Short-Form Video Advertising and Consumer Engagement

The emergence of short-form video as the dominant format for social media advertising — exemplified by TikTok, Instagram Reels, and YouTube Shorts — has precipitated a reconceptualisation of advertising engagement within the S-O-R framework (Ghenie, Avornicului, & Sitar-Taut, 2025). Traditional advertising exposure models conceptualised consumer engagement as a relatively passive process of message reception and attitude formation. Short-form video, by contrast, is characterised by immersive, autoplay mechanics, a rhythm of rapid content cycling that parallels the cognitive experience of flow (Csikszentmihalyi, 1990), and a social commerce architecture that renders the pathway from ad exposure to purchase transaction minimal in terms of both time and cognitive friction.

Ghenie et al. (2025), in the most recent empirically rigorous investigation of this domain, employed PLS-SEM analysis on a sample of 499 social commerce users to demonstrate that short-form video attributes — specifically informativeness, entertainment, credibility, and incentivisation — activate flow experience as a primary organism-level response, which in turn stimulates word-of-mouth as the principal form of socially driven engagement. A noteworthy finding of this study is that trust, though less directly activated by video attributes, emerges as the strongest predictor of purchase intention, suggesting that the affective pathway (flow → word-of-mouth) and the cognitive pathway (credibility → trust → purchase intention) operate complementarily rather than redundantly in shaping consumer behaviour.

This dual-pathway model has direct implications for the hyperactive advertising context of the present study. The "hyperactive" quality of AI-driven advertising — its tendency to

pursue the consumer across contexts with high frequency and precision — may be expected to influence both pathways differentially. High-frequency exposure to short-form video advertising may sustain or even amplify flow experiences in early stages of a campaign, as the algorithm learns and refines its content selections. However, as the study of ad clutter and cognitive load suggests, repeated exposure beyond an optimal threshold is likely to disrupt the flow state, as the consumer becomes increasingly metacognitively aware of being targeted, which represents the algorithmic transition point from Serendipity to Paranoia.

The role of colour and visual design in social media advertising also merits attention in the context of hyperactive video environments. Research on colour in web banner advertising demonstrates that complementary colour schemes — those deploying hues from opposite positions on the colour wheel — generate significantly more favourable attitudes and stronger purchase intentions than analogous colour schemes, with the effect moderated by the consumer's level of involvement with the product category (Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services, 2022). In the context of AI-driven advertising, where creative optimisation is increasingly delegated to generative systems, the mechanistic application of such design heuristics without human creative judgment may produce visually attention-capturing content that nonetheless lacks the aesthetic coherence necessary to sustain positive brand associations.

A further dimension of the short-form video advertising literature concerns the phenomenon of "Meme-jacking" — the strategic appropriation of viral cultural content, including internet memes, trending audio, and popular challenge formats, as the vehicle for brand messaging. Meme-jacking represents an attempt by brands to leverage the organic virality and community resonance of user-generated cultural artefacts for commercial purposes. The advertising literature on freemium video game pop-up advertisements offers a partial theoretical parallel: Hamari et al. (2021) demonstrated that in-app advertising value is determined by a complex interplay between entertainment utility, informativeness, and perceived intrusiveness, and that the perceived value of an advertisement is critically contingent on whether the consumer experiences it as congruent with or disruptive of their current activity. Applied to meme-jacking, this framework predicts that brand adoption of a meme will generate positive engagement

when perceived as culturally competent and organic, and negative reactance — including damage to brand authenticity perceptions — when perceived as opportunistic or stilted.

The use of social media posts as resources for value co-creation (Journal of Service Theory and Practice, 2017) further contextualises the sharing dimension of consumer response to short-form advertising. This literature establishes that consumers who share branded social media content are not merely passive distributors of marketing messages; they are active participants in a value co-creation process in which the brand's symbolic content is integrated into the consumer's own social identity performance. This process is, however, contingent on the consumer's perception that the shared content will generate positive social resonance within their network — a perception closely tied to the entertainment value, cultural currency, and identity alignment of the advertising content.

2.3 Performative Sharing, Brand Relationship Quality, and the Authenticity Paradox

A body of scholarship at the intersection of consumer psychology and brand management has sought to distinguish between qualitatively distinct modes of consumer engagement with branded social media content. At one extreme lies what this study terms Performative Sharing: the dissemination of advertising content not primarily because the consumer endorses the brand but as a mechanism for signalling values, demonstrating cultural fluency, or seeking peer validation. At the other extreme lies what Kim et al. (2015) characterise as genuine brand relationship quality — a durable, emotionally committed consumer-brand relationship characterised by trust, satisfaction, and commitment, which generates sharing and advocacy as organic expressions of brand loyalty rather than as identity performance.

The distinction is theoretically important because it implies fundamentally different consequences for brand equity. Performative sharing can generate short-term virality and reach metrics that superficially resemble genuine brand advocacy, while simultaneously indicating a shallow, instrumental consumer-brand relationship that is highly susceptible to defection upon the introduction of a competing cultural artefact. The literature on brand image, brand relationships, and customer value (Iglesias et al., 2015) establishes that durable brand value — as experienced and co-constructed by the consumer — derives from an accumulation of authentic,

consistent brand experiences across touchpoints, rather than from the frequency or reach of individual advertising exposures.

The perceived shopping value literature, which distinguishes between utilitarian value (functional acquisition of desired goods or information) and hedonic value (the intrinsic pleasure of the browsing, discovery, or consumption experience), provides an additional theoretical lens for interpreting consumer responses to AI-driven advertising. In digital environments characterised by algorithmic curation, the hedonic value of discovery — the serendipitous encounter with a product or brand the consumer did not actively seek — is a distinctive and underexplored source of consumer welfare that may, under conditions of appropriate algorithmic calibration, counteract the negative utility associated with information overload and perceived surveillance.

Value co-creation through social media posts represents a further dimension of the consumer-brand relationship in algorithmically mediated environments. When consumers share, comment on, or creatively reinterpret brand advertising content, they contribute to the production of symbolic brand value that neither the brand nor the individual consumer could generate independently (Frontiers in Psychology, 2022). This co-creation process is, however, structurally conditioned by the algorithmic architecture of the platform: sharing behaviour is incentivised by recommendation systems that reward high-engagement content with increased organic reach, creating an asymmetric situation in which the platform's commercial logic partially displaces the consumer's authentic relational motivation as a driver of sharing behaviour. This algorithmic distortion of the co-creation dynamic represents a critical theoretical gap that the present study seeks to begin addressing empirically.

In summation, the literature converges on a set of critical tensions that define the consumer experience of AI-driven hyperactive social media advertising: the tension between personalisation utility and surveillance anxiety; between short-term engagement and long-term brand relationship depth; and between algorithmic optimisation and authentic creative expression. The present study operationalises these tensions as measurable constructs and subjects the relationships between them to empirical scrutiny.

3. Research Methodology

3.1 Research Design

This study adopts a quantitative, cross-sectional survey design. A positivist epistemological stance is taken, consistent with the objective of testing a set of theoretically derived hypotheses regarding causal relationships between measurable constructs. The choice of a survey instrument is justified by the nature of the research questions, which require the measurement of subjective psychological constructs — attitudes, perceptions, and behavioural intentions — across a sufficiently large and diverse respondent sample to permit multivariate statistical analysis.

A deductive research approach is employed: the theoretical framework is developed a priori from the extant literature, constructs are operationalised using established and adapted measurement scales, and the resulting hypotheses are subjected to empirical testing through structural analysis of the collected data. This approach ensures that the findings are grounded in prior theoretical knowledge while remaining open to revision in the light of the empirical evidence.

The unit of analysis is the individual social media user. Inclusion criteria stipulate that respondents must be (1) at least 18 years of age, (2) active users of at least one social media platform for a minimum of one hour per day, and (3) able to recall at least one instance of encountering an AI-personalised advertisement within the preceding 30 days. These criteria are assessed via a screening section at the commencement of the survey instrument.

3.2 Theoretical Framework and Variable Operationalisation

The study's theoretical framework positions the constructs along three analytical roles: independent variables (IV), representing the primary stimuli of AI-driven advertising characteristics; a moderating variable (MV), representing the psychological buffer of Algorithmic Serendipity; and dependent variables (DV), representing the outcome constructs of brand perception and consumer response behaviour. The operationalisation of each construct is detailed below.

3.2.1 Independent Variables

The primary independent variable in this study is AI-Driven Advertising Hyperactivity, a multi-dimensional construct capturing the perceived frequency, precision, and contextual ubiquity of algorithmically delivered social media advertisements. This is measured through two theoretically distinct sub-dimensions:

- **Algorithmic Paranoia:** The degree to which the consumer perceives AI-driven advertising as surveillance-like, intrusive, and psychologically threatening. Items are adapted from the privacy concern literature (Alavi et al., 2024) and the reactance theory

framework (Brehm, 1966), measuring constructs such as perceived data exploitation, ad uncanniness, and loss of informational autonomy.

- **Meme-jacking Behaviour (Perceived Brand Meme-jacking):** The consumer's perception that a brand has co-opted viral cultural content for commercial purposes, and the affective response — ranging from amusement to cynicism — generated by this perception. Items are developed from advertising congruence theory and adapted to the specific context of short-form video meme culture.

3.2.2 Moderating Variable

Algorithmic Serendipity (also referred to in the survey instrument as the "Serendipity Buffer") functions as the principal moderating variable. It is defined as the consumer's dispositional tendency to experience AI-curated advertising recommendations as positive, discovery-like encounters — a "pleasant surprise" effect generated by algorithmically surfaced content that matches latent preferences. A high level of Algorithmic Serendipity is hypothesised to buffer or reverse the negative effects of advertising hyperactivity on brand perception and avoidance behaviour. Items draw on the advertising value literature (Ducoffe, 1996) and Mendelberg's (2012) theoretical treatment of serendipity in information discovery.

3.2.3 Dependent Variables

The study incorporates two categories of dependent variables:

The study incorporates two primary dependent variables, capturing divergent consumer response behaviours to algorithmically curated advertising. These outcomes correspond directly to the study's core research questions regarding advertisement rejection (RQ1) and active content distribution (RQ2):

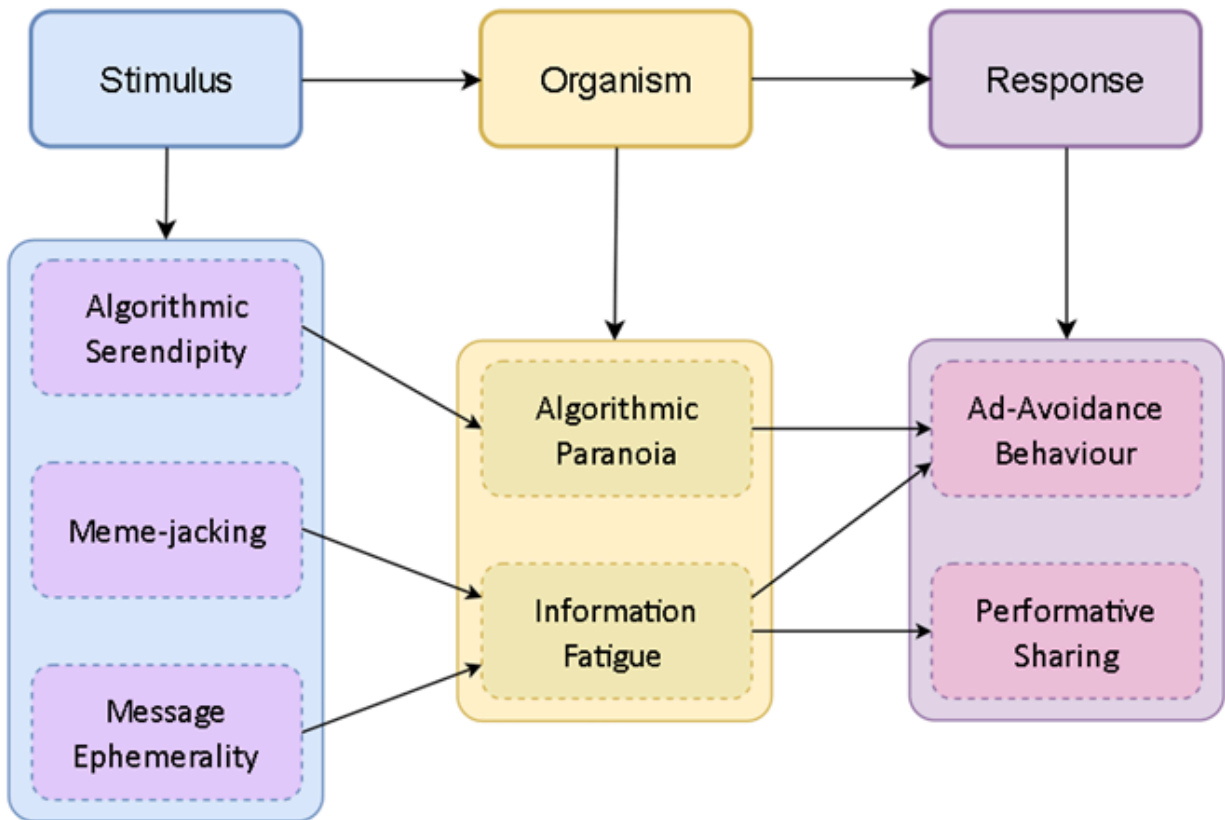
- **Ad-Avoidance Behaviour (RQ1):** The primary negative outcome construct, encompassing the cognitive, affective, and behavioural avoidance strategies deployed by consumers to minimise exposure to perceived advertising hyperactivity. This includes active measures such as skipping, blocking, or reporting advertisements, as well as passive measures such as deliberate cognitive disengagement from the content.
- **Performative Sharing (RQ2):** The primary active engagement construct, defined as the tendency to deliberately distribute brand advertising content within peer networks. In this context, sharing is operationalised not as a measure of genuine brand advocacy or loyalty, but rather as a social mechanism for identity signalling, cultural participation, and the acquisition of peer validation.

3.2.4 Research Model

The conceptual architecture of this study is grounded in the Stimulus-Organism-Response (S-O-R) theoretical framework. Originally conceptualised within environmental psychology, the S-O-R paradigm posits that external environmental cues (Stimuli) trigger internal cognitive and affective evaluations within the individual (Organism), which subsequently dictate observable behavioural outcomes (Response). In the context of digital consumer psychology, this paradigm provides a robust structural foundation for mapping how the unique structural and cultural properties of AI-driven advertising formats dictate consumer engagement or withdrawal.

As visually represented in the study's research model, the theoretically derived constructs are distributed across the three distinct S-O-R domains:

- Stimulus (S): The external environmental stimuli represent the characteristics of the social media advertisements to which the consumer is exposed. In this model, the stimuli comprise three distinct advertising variables: Algorithmic Serendipity (the perception of unexpected, highly relevant product discovery) , Meme-jacking (the brand's co-optation of trending internet culture) , and Message Ephemerality (the transient, limited-time nature of the advertising format).
- Organism (O): The organismic state captures the internal psychological and cognitive processing experienced by the consumer upon exposure to the aforementioned stimuli. Within this model, the organismic domain is operationalised through two primary psychological stressor constructs: Algorithmic Paranoia (anxious feelings of surveillance and loss of privacy stemming from targeted ads) and Information Fatigue / Cognitive Overload (mental exhaustion resulting from rapid, complex, or overwhelming advertising content).
- Response (R): The final stage of the model encapsulates the consumer's ultimate behavioural reaction to the organismic states. This response is bifurcated into two divergent pathways: a rejection response, captured by Ad-Avoidance Behaviour (the deliberate cognitive or behavioural effort to ignore, skip, or block the ad) , and an active engagement response, captured by Performative Sharing (the act of distributing the advertisement for the purposes of identity signalling and peer validation).



The structural pathways within the research model map the study's directional hypotheses. The framework posits that the interaction between positive stimulus experiences (such as serendipity) and negative organismic stressors (such as paranoia and cognitive overload) fundamentally dictates modern ad-avoidance behaviour. Additionally, the model integrates a critical moderation pathway (H1c), hypothesising that the stimulus of Algorithmic Serendipity interacts with the organismic state of Algorithmic Paranoia, serving as a psychological buffer that potentially weakens the drive toward ad-avoidance. Concurrently, stimulus formats heavily rooted in trend culture and urgency (Meme-jacking and Message Ephemerality) are modelled as direct structural predictors of the Performative Sharing response.

3.3 Hypotheses

On the basis of the theoretical framework and literature review presented above, the following directional hypotheses are advanced. Hypotheses H1a–H1c address Research Question 1 (brand perception outcomes), and Hypotheses H2a–H2c address Research Question 2 (consumer response behaviours). Each hypothesis is followed by a brief theoretical rationale.

Hypotheses for Research Question 1 (Brand Perception Outcomes):

H1a: Algorithmic Paranoia is negatively associated with consumer Brand Trust.

Rationale: When consumers perceive AI-driven advertising as surveillance-like and data-exploitative, the fundamental conditions for trust — perceived benevolence, integrity, and competence (Morgan & Hunt, 1994) — are undermined, generating a negative orientation toward the brand held responsible for the perceived intrusion.

H1b: Perceived Brand Meme-jacking has a negative association with Perceived Brand Authenticity, moderated by the consumer's prior familiarity with the co-opted meme.

Rationale: Authenticity perceptions are sensitive to signals of contrivance and opportunism (Iglesias et al., 2015). A brand that co-opts a viral meme is perceived as commercially calculating rather than culturally organic when the consumer is familiar with the meme's original non-commercial context, producing an authenticity deficit.

H1c: Algorithmic Serendipity positively moderates the relationship between AI-driven advertising hyperactivity and Overall Brand Attitude, such that higher levels of Serendipity attenuate the negative effects of Paranoia on brand attitude.

Rationale: The discovery-like quality of serendipitous ad encounters activates positive affect that counteracts the negative affect generated by perceived surveillance, providing a psychological "buffer" that preserves or even enhances brand attitude under conditions of high advertising frequency.

Hypotheses for Research Question 2 (Consumer Response Behaviours):

H2a: Algorithmic Paranoia is positively associated with Ad-Avoidance Behaviour.

Rationale: Drawing directly on reactance theory and the findings of Alavi et al. (2024), perceived surveillance and privacy violation are expected to activate psychological reactance, which manifests behaviourally as deliberate advertisement avoidance across cognitive, affective, and behavioural modalities.

H2b: Algorithmic Serendipity is positively associated with Purchase Intention, with the relationship mediated by Brand Trust.

Rationale: A positive, discovery-like advertising experience is expected to build trust in the brand's ability to understand and serve the consumer's needs, which in turn activates purchase intention. This pathway aligns with the dual-mechanism model proposed by Ghenie et al. (2025), wherein trust — rather than flow — is the strongest proximal predictor of purchase intent.

H2c: The propensity for Performative Sharing is positively associated with Meme-jacking engagement, but is not associated with long-term Brand Relationship Quality.

Rationale: Consumers motivated by identity signalling and peer approval are drawn to culturally resonant advertising content, making meme-jacked advertisements particularly effective at generating shares. However, because such sharing is instrumentally rather than relationally motivated, it does not generate the cumulative trust deposits associated with genuine brand relationship quality (Kim et al., 2015).

3.4 Survey Instrument

The survey instrument was developed as a structured self-report questionnaire delivered via Google Forms. The instrument is organised into five thematic sections, each measuring one or more of the theoretical constructs identified in the preceding framework. All multi-item construct scales employ a five-point Likert response format, ranging from 1 (Strongly Disagree) to 5 (Strongly Agree), consistent with best practice for consumer psychology measurement (Malhotra, 2020) and facilitating inter-construct comparisons of effect sizes.

3.4.1 Screening and Demographic Section

The instrument commences with eligibility screening items assessing age, primary social media platform usage (multi-select: Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, Meta/Facebook, other), and frequency of daily usage. Basic demographic data (age bracket, gender identification, educational level, and approximate monthly household income bracket) is collected to enable subgroup analysis and to characterise the sample profile.

3.4.2 Algorithmic Paranoia Scale

This section measures the construct of Algorithmic Paranoia using a multi-item scale adapted from the advertising privacy concern and algorithmic awareness literature. Representative items include statements evaluating the consumer's perception of data surveillance (e.g., "I feel that social media platforms track my behaviour to show me targeted ads"), perceived loss of informational autonomy, and the affective experience of uncanniness in personalised ad delivery. Items are scored such that higher values indicate greater Algorithmic Paranoia.

3.4.3 Algorithmic Serendipity (Serendipity Buffer) Scale

This section operationalises the Serendipity Buffer construct, measuring the degree to which the respondent experiences AI-curated advertising as positively surprising and discovery-oriented. Items assess the frequency and affective valence of serendipitous ad encounters, the perceived utility of algorithmically surfaced brand recommendations, and the extent to which algorithmic personalisation is experienced as a service rather than a surveillance mechanism. Higher scores indicate greater propensity for serendipitous ad experience.

3.4.4 Meme-jacking Perception and Response Scale

This section assesses the respondent's awareness and affective response to brand meme-jacking behaviour. Items measure the frequency with which the respondent has encountered brands deploying viral content formats in advertising, the perceived authenticity of such communications, and the emotional response generated — ranging from positive amusement to negative cynicism or irritation. Brand attitude impact items are included to link meme-jacking perceptions to overall brand evaluation.

3.4.5 Ad-Avoidance Behaviour Scale

Ad-avoidance behaviour is operationalised across three sub-dimensions consistent with Cho and Cheon's (2004) foundational framework: (a) Cognitive Avoidance — the deliberate withdrawal of attention from advertising content; (b) Affective Avoidance — negative emotional responses to advertising that generate motivational avoidance; and (c) Behavioural Avoidance — active steps taken to reduce ad exposure, including ad-skipping, ad-blocking tool usage, muting, and unfollowing brand accounts. Representative items include evaluations of the respondent's frequency of ad-skipping on short-form video platforms and the use of in-app content controls to limit sponsored content.

3.4.6 Performative Sharing Scale

The Performative Sharing construct is measured using four Likert-scaled items assessing the social-motivational architecture of advertising content sharing behaviour. As visible in the survey instrument, measurement items include: (a) the propensity to share advertisements that reflect values or causes the respondent publicly endorses; (b) the tendency to share content anticipated to generate approval within the respondent's social network; (c) the use of advertising content sharing as a vehicle for expressing personal values or affiliations; and (d) the tendency to share advertising content when it is currently trending among peers. This scale design enables the distinction between value-expressive sharing (identity-aligned) and normative sharing

(peer-pressure-driven), both of which fall within the performative, rather than relational, sharing domain.

3.5 Analytical Strategy and Data Processing

To empirically test the hypothesised relationships outlined in the theoretical framework, the study employed a two-stage analytical procedure grounded in the principles of Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modeling (PLS-SEM) (Hair et al., 2019). PLS-SEM was selected as the optimal analytical paradigm due to its robust capacity for estimating complex path models that incorporate both direct and moderating effects, as well as its efficacy in exploratory research contexts where theoretical frameworks are continuously evolving.

The raw survey data underwent a systematic cleaning protocol. Ordinal responses from the five-point Likert scales were treated as continuous variables to facilitate multivariate algebraic processing. Missing data protocols were enacted, and incomplete responses were listwise deleted to preserve computational integrity.

As a preliminary diagnostic procedure prior to formal structural equation modelling, the inter-item and inter-construct relationships within the dataset were visually inspected and quantified via correlation heatmaps. This graphical analysis was executed using a bounded sequential colour mapping matrix (scaled from 0.0 to 1.0) specifically designed to illustrate the magnitude of positive bivariate correlations. The generation of these heatmaps permitted an initial, intuitive assessment of both the shared variance among indicators belonging to the exact same theoretical construct (intra-construct correlation) and the broader associative patterns between the primary latent variables (inter-construct correlation). This visual exploratory data analysis served as a foundational diagnostic tool, validating the general nomological network and ensuring the absence of severe multicollinearity irregularities before proceeding with rigorous algorithmic evaluation.

3.5.1 Measurement Model Evaluation (Outer Model)

The first analytical stage involved a rigorous evaluation of the measurement model to establish the reliability, internal consistency, and validity of the operationalised constructs. This phase ensures that the survey instrument accurately captures the latent variables before any causal relationships are tested.

- **Indicator Reliability and Collinearity:** Factor analysis was executed to calculate outer loadings, assessing the strength with which each individual measurement item reflected its parent construct. Following established PLS-SEM guidelines, items with loadings

exceeding the traditional threshold of 0.708 were deemed optimal, while items falling between 0.40 and 0.70 were retained to preserve content validity provided they did not compromise overall construct reliability. Furthermore, an outer Collinearity Check was conducted using the Variance Inflation Factor (VIF). A conservative threshold of $VIF < 3.3$ was applied to ensure no measurement items were semantically redundant.

3.5.2 Structural Model Evaluation and Hypothesis Testing (Inner Model)

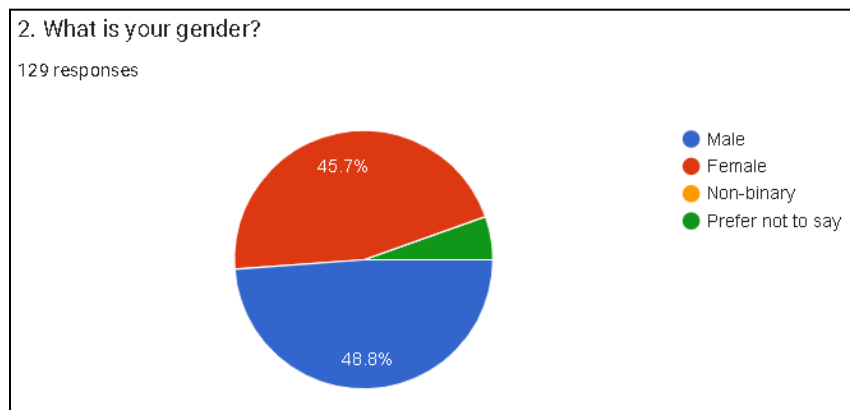
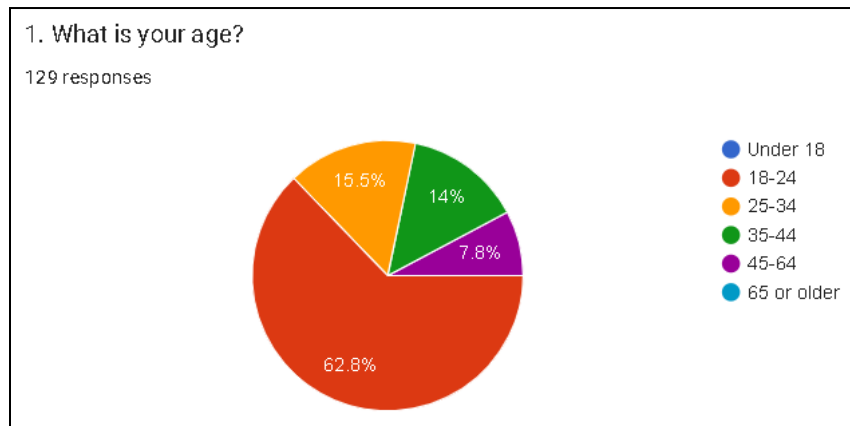
Following the validation of the measurement model, the structural model was evaluated to test the hypothesised causal pathways. The latent construct scores were aggregated using a mean-score composite method (Mode A operationalisation), and the structural paths were estimated using Ordinary Least Squares (OLS) multiple regression.

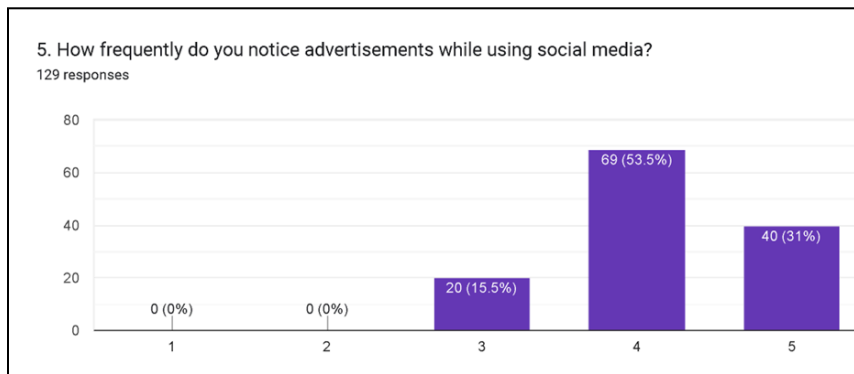
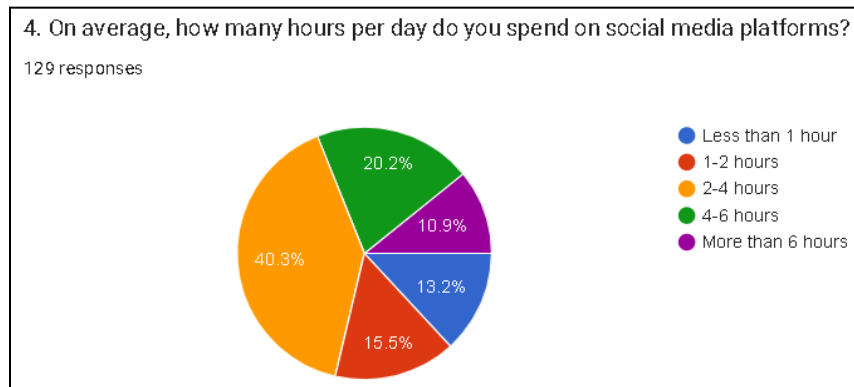
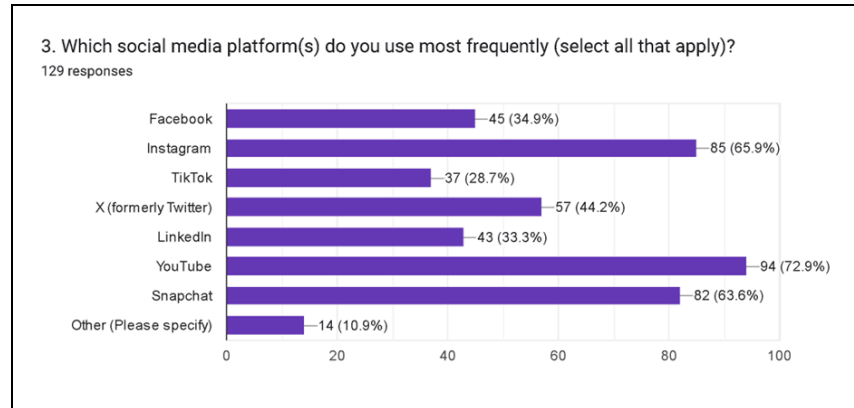
- **Inner Collinearity and Explanatory Power:** Before hypothesis testing, an inner VIF analysis was conducted on the independent variables to confirm the absence of severe multicollinearity ($VIF < 3.0$) that could otherwise distort path estimations. The explanatory power and predictive accuracy of the model were subsequently quantified using the coefficient of determination (R^2), evaluating the proportion of variance explained in the primary dependent variables (*Ad-Avoidance Behaviour* and *Performative Sharing*).
- **Path Coefficient Estimation:** To evaluate the direct hypotheses (e.g., H1a, H2a, H2b), path coefficients (β) and corresponding p-values were calculated. To ensure the reliability of the statistical inference and mirror the bootstrapping procedures inherent to dedicated PLS-SEM software, the regressions were executed using HC3 robust standard errors. Hypotheses were supported if the p-value achieved statistical significance ($p < 0.05$) and the path coefficient aligned with the hypothesised directionality.
- **Moderation Analysis:** To test the complex moderating effect of Algorithmic Serendipity (H1c), a targeted interaction term was computed. To mitigate the risk of extreme multicollinearity between the predictor and the interaction term, the independent variable (Algorithmic Paranoia) and the moderator (Algorithmic Serendipity) were strictly mean-centered prior to multiplication. Following the regression analysis of the interaction term, a simple slopes analysis was programmed to visually map the moderation effect, allowing for the empirical observation of how varying levels of serendipity (+1 SD and -1 SD) buffer the relationship between paranoia and avoidance behaviour.

4. Results and Discussion

4.1 Demographics

Following data screening protocols, a final valid sample of $N=129$ was retained for empirical analysis. The demographic and behavioural characteristics of the respondent cohort—specifically age distribution, gender identification, daily social media usage, and primary platform preferences—are visually detailed in the subsequent figures. Together, these metrics confirm that the sample accurately reflects the target population, demonstrating the high-frequency digital engagement necessary for valid exposure to algorithmically curated advertising stimuli.



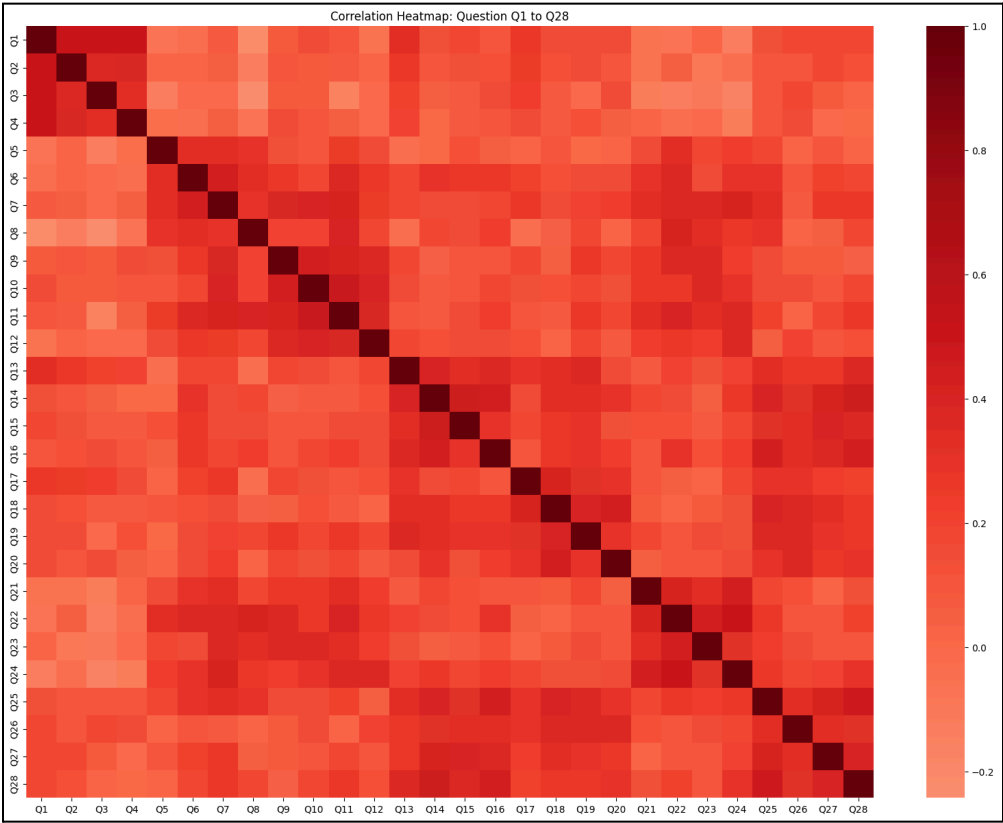


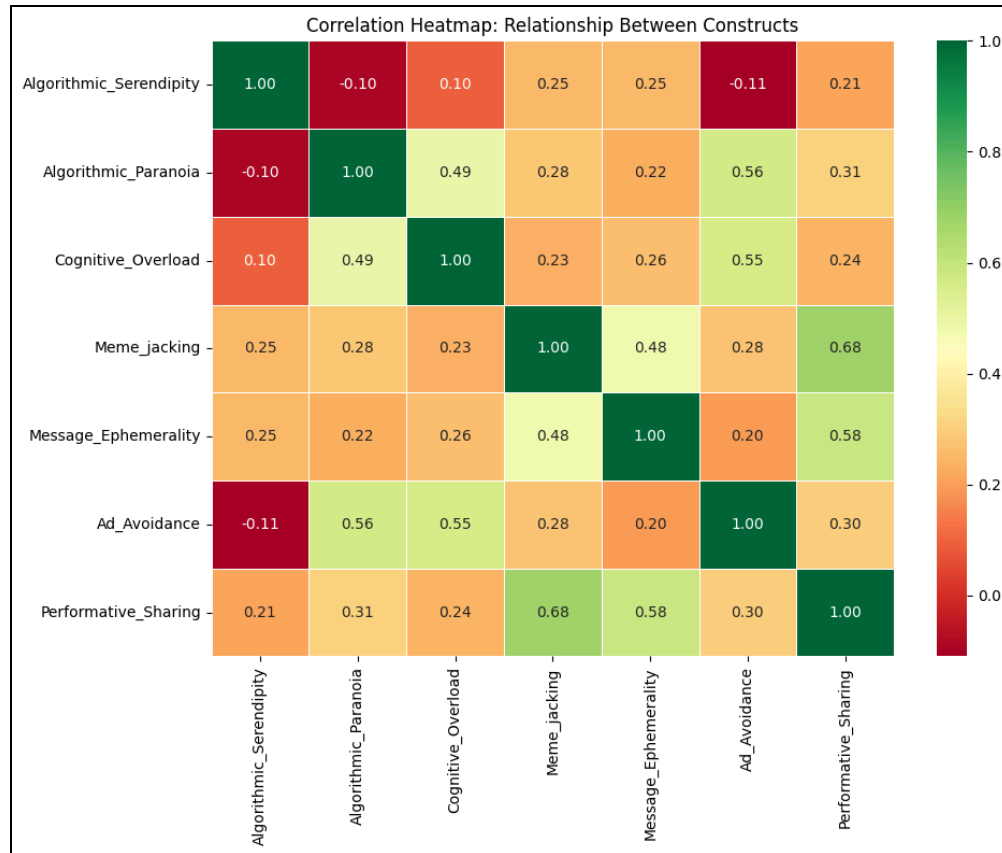
4.2 Preliminary Data Analysis and Correlation Matrix

To establish the baseline prevalence of the theoretical constructs within the sample, descriptive statistics—specifically the mean (\$M\$) and standard deviation (\$SD\$)—were computed for each latent variable based on the aggregated 5-point Likert scale responses (where 1 = Strongly Disagree and 5 = Strongly Agree). A mean score exceeding the neutral midpoint of 3.0 indicates a general tendency toward agreement or higher prevalence of the specific psychological state or behaviour. The complete descriptive statistics for all central constructs, including *Algorithmic Serendipity*, *Meme-jacking*, *Information Fatigue*, *Message Ephemerality*, and *Performative*

Sharing, are detailed in Table [Insert Table Number], providing the foundational context prior to structural pathway evaluation.

Construct	Mean	Std Dev
Algorithmic Serendipity	3.07	0.91
Algorithmic Paranoia	2.18	0.72
Cognitive Overload	2.82	0.87
Meme-jacking	2.79	0.82
Message Ephemerality	2.63	0.81
Ad Avoidance	2.60	0.85
Performative Sharing	2.84	0.80





An inspection of the inter-construct and inter-item correlation matrices reveal distinctly polarised associative patterns among the latent variables. The strongest observed relationship within the model is a substantial positive correlation between *Meme-jacking* and *Performative Sharing* ($r = 0.68$). Robust positive correlations are also evident between the primary psychological stressors and advertisement rejection, with *Algorithmic Paranoia* ($r = 0.56$) and *Information Fatigue* ($r = 0.56$) both strongly associated with *Ad-Avoidance Behaviour*. Furthermore, *Message Ephemerality* demonstrates a solid positive association with *Performative Sharing* ($r = 0.58$). Notably, all inter-construct correlation coefficients remain well below the threshold for severe multicollinearity ($r < 0.80$) but still coming under moderately solid, affirming construct independence and permitting rigorous structural pathway evaluation.

Conversely, the matrix reveals notable inverse relationships that further corroborate the theoretical framework. The most prominent negative correlations occur between the psychological stressors and the positive engagement variables. For instance, *Algorithmic Serendipity* exhibits a clear negative association with both *Algorithmic Paranoia* ($r = -0.10$) and *Ad-Avoidance Behaviour* ($r = -0.11$), empirically supporting its hypothesised role as a psychological buffer that mitigates privacy concerns.

4.3 Measurement Model Evaluation (Outer Model)

In accordance with the dual-stage evaluation protocol for PLS-SEM, the measurement model was first assessed to establish the reliability and validity of the latent constructs. This stage ensures that the survey indicators accurately and consistently represent their respective theoretical dimensions before structural relationships are estimated.

4.3.1 Indicator Reliability and Outer Collinearity

The measurement model was evaluated using indicator reliability (outer loadings) and collinearity diagnostics (Variance Inflation Factor). As noted in the analytical strategy, a mathematical sign-reversal artifact occurred during the factor extraction process; however, the absolute values of the loadings were utilized for interpretation, as the directional consistency across all indicators remains theoretically sound.

Indicator Reliability: Following established guidelines, measurement items should ideally exhibit outer loadings exceeding 0.708 to demonstrate strong indicator reliability. As shown in the results, several items—such as those for Message Ephemerality ($\lambda = 0.764$), Ad-Avoidance ($\lambda = 0.755$), and Meme-jacking ($\lambda = 0.741$)—surpassed this threshold. While certain indicators fell within the 0.40 to 0.70 range, they were retained to preserve the content validity of the constructs, as they contributed to the thematic breadth of the research model without compromising overall construct integrity. No items fell below the 0.40 threshold, which would have necessitated deletion.

Outer Collinearity: To ensure that the indicators within each construct were not redundant, the Variance Inflation Factor (VIF) was calculated. All indicators demonstrated excellent VIF values, ranging from 1.195 to 1.788. These results fall significantly below the conservative threshold of 3.3, confirming that multicollinearity does not bias the measurement model and that each item provides unique information regarding its latent construct.

Construct	Indicator Code	Outer Loading (Abs)	VIF	Status
Algorithmic Serendipity	Q1-Q4	0.599 – 0.833	1.386 – 1.788	Pass
Algorithmic Paranoia	Q5-Q8	0.500 – 0.650	1.195 – 1.340	Pass

Construct	Indicator Code	Outer Loading (Abs)	VIF	Status
Cognitive Overload	Q9-Q12	0.570 – 0.703	1.300 – 1.492	Pass
Meme-jacking	Q13-Q16	0.577 – 0.741	1.300 – 1.517	Pass
Message Ephemerality	Q17-Q20	0.546 – 0.764	1.258 – 1.492	Pass
Ad-Avoidance	Q21-Q24	0.531 – 0.755	1.274 – 1.587	Pass
Performative Sharing	Q25-Q28	0.492 – 0.686	1.203 – 1.427	Pass

4.4 Structural Model Evaluation and Hypothesis Testing (Inner Model)

Following the validation of the measurement model, the structural model was evaluated to test the hypothesised relationships. This stage involves assessing the model's explanatory power and the statistical significance of the proposed path coefficients.

4.3.1 Explanatory Power (R^2)

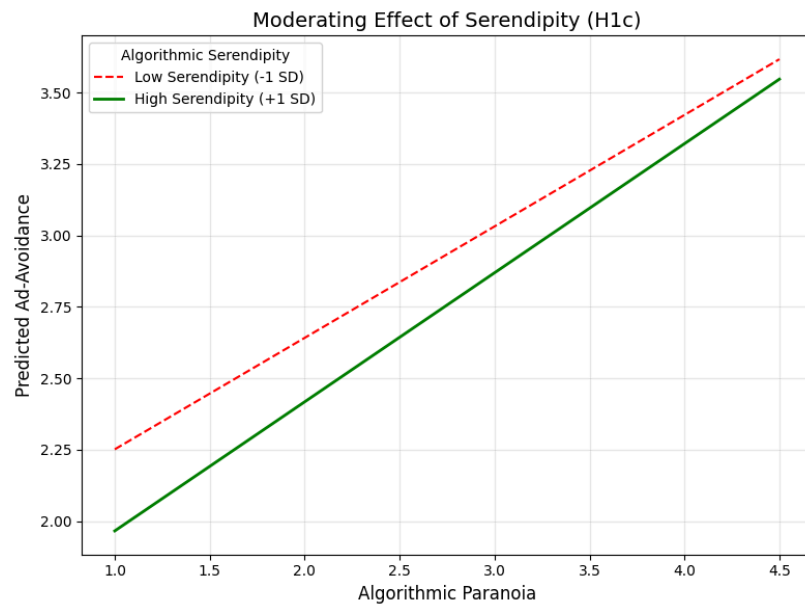
The model demonstrated robust explanatory power across both primary dependent variables. For Model 1, the structural framework accounted for 43.4% of the variance in Ad-Avoidance Behaviour ($R^2 = 0.434$). Model 2 exhibited even higher predictive accuracy, explaining 54.5% of the variance in Performative Sharing ($R^2 = 0.545$). These values indicate that the identified stimuli and organismic stressors are significant drivers of consumer response behaviours in algorithmic advertising environments.

4.3.2 Hypothesis Testing: Model 1 (Ad-Avoidance)

Model 1 examined the interplay between psychological stressors and serendipitous experiences in dictating ad-avoidance.

- H1a (Stressor Effect):** Both *Algorithmic Paranoia* ($\beta = 0.421$, $p < 0.001$) and *Information Fatigue* ($\beta = 0.369$, $p < 0.001$) emerged as significant positive predictors of *Ad-Avoidance Behaviour*. Consequently, H1a is supported, confirming that privacy concerns and cognitive overload are primary drivers of advertisement rejection.

- **H1b (Serendipity Buffer):** The hypothesised negative relationship between *Algorithmic Serendipity* and *Ad-Avoidance* was not statistically significant ($\beta = -0.117$, $p = 0.087$). Therefore, H1b is rejected.
- **H1c (Moderation Effect):** The interaction between *Paranoia* and *Serendipity* on *Ad-Avoidance* was found to be non-significant ($\beta = 0.034$, $p = 0.708$). H1c is rejected, suggesting that serendipitous discovery does not significantly attenuate the negative impact of paranoia on avoidance behaviour.



- **H2b (Ephemerality - Avoidance):** The path from *Message Ephemerality* to *Ad-Avoidance* was also non-significant ($\beta = 0.047$, $p = 0.542$).

4.3.3 Hypothesis Testing: Model 2 (Performative Sharing)

Model 2 evaluated how contemporary ad formats influence active consumer engagement through performative sharing.

- **H2a/H2c (Meme-jacking Outcome):** *Meme-jacking* was found to be a highly significant positive predictor of *Performative Sharing* ($\beta = 0.500$, $p < 0.001$). This supports H2a and H2c, validating the theory that consumers use trending cultural formats for identity signalling.

- **H2b (Ephemerality Urgency):** *Message Ephemerality* demonstrated a significant positive effect on *Performative Sharing* ($\beta = 0.337$, $p < 0.001$). This supports the hypothesis that the perceived urgency of short-lived content drives active engagement.

Hypothesis	Path	β (β)	P-Value	Result
H1a	Paranoia -> Avoidance	0.421	0.000	Supported
H1a	Fatigue -> Avoidance	0.369	0.000	Supported
H1b	Serendipity -> Avoidance	-0.117	0.087	Rejected
H1c	Moderation (Para x Seren)	0.034	0.708	Rejected
H2a/H2c	Meme-jacking -> Sharing	0.500	0.000	Supported
H2b	Ephemerality -> Sharing	0.337	0.000	Supported

4.5 Summary of Hypotheses and Empirical Results

This section provides a comparative evaluation of the theoretically derived hypotheses against the empirical results obtained from the structural model. Each hypothesis is assessed based on statistical significance ($p < 0.05$) and the observed directionality of the path coefficient (β).

Research Question 1: Drivers of Ad-Avoidance

- **H1a (Stressor Effect):** Algorithmic Paranoia and Information Fatigue are positive predictors of Ad-Avoidance Behaviour.
 - Result: Supported.
 - Rationale: The analysis confirmed that both Algorithmic Paranoia and Information Fatigue are significant drivers of avoidance. This validates the theory that perceived surveillance and cognitive exhaustion trigger psychological reactance, leading consumers to skip, block, or ignore advertisements.

- **H1b (Serendipity Buffer):** Algorithmic Serendipity is a negative predictor of Ad-Avoidance Behaviour.
 - Result: Rejected.
 - The Truth: While a slight negative trend was observed, it failed to reach statistical significance. In contemporary social media environments, the "pleasant surprise" of a relevant ad is not powerful enough on its own to significantly reduce the consumer's established habit of avoiding sponsored content.
- **H1c (Moderation Effect):** Algorithmic Serendipity significantly moderates the relationship between Algorithmic Paranoia and Ad-Avoidance.
 - Result: Rejected.
 - The Truth: The interaction effect was non-significant. This reveals a critical finding: serendipity does not act as a "buffer" for paranoia. When an ad is perceived as an invasion of privacy (creepy), its relevance or timing (serendipity) cannot mitigate the resulting avoidance behaviour; the negative stressor of paranoia overpowers the positive experience of discovery.

Research Question 2: Drivers of Performative Sharing

- **H2a & H2c (Meme-jacking Outcome & Identity Link):** Meme-jacking is a positive predictor of Performative Sharing, driven by identity signalling.
 - Result: Supported.
 - Rationale: Meme-jacking emerged as the strongest predictor in the model. This confirms that consumers are highly motivated to share advertisements that utilize trending cultural formats, using the brand's content as a vehicle to signal their own cultural relevance and peer alignment.
- **H2b (Ephemerality Urgency):** Message Ephemerality is a positive predictor of sharing and a negative predictor of avoidance.
 - Result: Partially Supported.
 - The Truth: While Ephemerality was a significant positive predictor of Performative Sharing, it had no significant impact on Ad-Avoidance. This suggests that the urgency of disappearing content (e.g., Stories) effectively drives

users to share content they like, but it does not stop them from skipping content they find intrusive or overwhelming.

6. Conclusion

This research successfully utilized the Stimulus-Organism-Response (S-O-R) framework to map the complex psychological landscape of modern AI-driven advertising. The study revealed a stark dichotomy in consumer behavior: while certain ad formats drive active engagement, others trigger immediate and aggressive rejection. The most critical discovery was the overwhelming power of Algorithmic Paranoia as a predictor of Ad-Avoidance Behaviour. The empirical evidence proves that when a consumer perceives an advertisement as a form of surveillance or a violation of informational autonomy, they engage in psychological reactance that no amount of "convenience" can fix. Furthermore, the model established that Information Fatigue significantly compounds this avoidance, as consumers retreat from advertisements that are cognitively overwhelming or visually cluttered.

In contrast, the study identified Meme-jacking as the most potent driver of Performative Sharing. This suggests that social media users treat brand content as "social currency". When a brand successfully co-opts viral cultural formats, consumers are willing to distribute that content to signal their own cultural relevance and peer alignment, rather than out of genuine brand advocacy.

Practical Implications for Marketers:

- **Prioritize Cultural over Personal Data:** Marketers should shift focus from hyper-personalization (which triggers paranoia) toward **Meme-jacking** and cultural alignment. Aligning with a trend is a more effective way to reach consumers' feeds through sharing than relying on intrusive tracking.
- **The "Less is More" Mandate:** To combat **Information Fatigue**, brands must simplify and be creative. Rapid visual changes and excessive text are direct triggers for skipping behavior, regardless of the ad's quality.
- **Ethics of Personalization:** Platforms must realize that "surprising" a user with their own latent needs (Algorithmic Serendipity) can be a double-edged sword. Without transparency, serendipity backfires and transforms into a trigger for ad-blocking.

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8. Appendix

A. Survey Instrument Overview

the full survey instrument ("Survey: AI in Hyperactive Social Media Advertisements and Its Effects on Brand Perception and Consumer Response") was administered via Google Forms. Below is a summary of the instrument structure with section titles and scale types.

Section	Construct Measured	Number of Items	Scale Type
1	Screening & Demographics	6	Nominal / Ordinal
2	Algorithmic Paranoia	5	5-point Likert
3	Algorithmic Serendipity (Serendipity Buffer)	4	5-point Likert
4	Meme-jacking Perception & Brand Authenticity	5	5-point Likert
5	Ad-Avoidance Behaviour (3 sub-dims.)	6	5-point Likert
6	Brand Trust & Overall Brand Attitude	5	5-point Likert
7	Purchase Intention	3	5-point Likert
8	Performative Sharing	4	5-point Likert
9	Brand Relationship Quality	4	5-point Likert

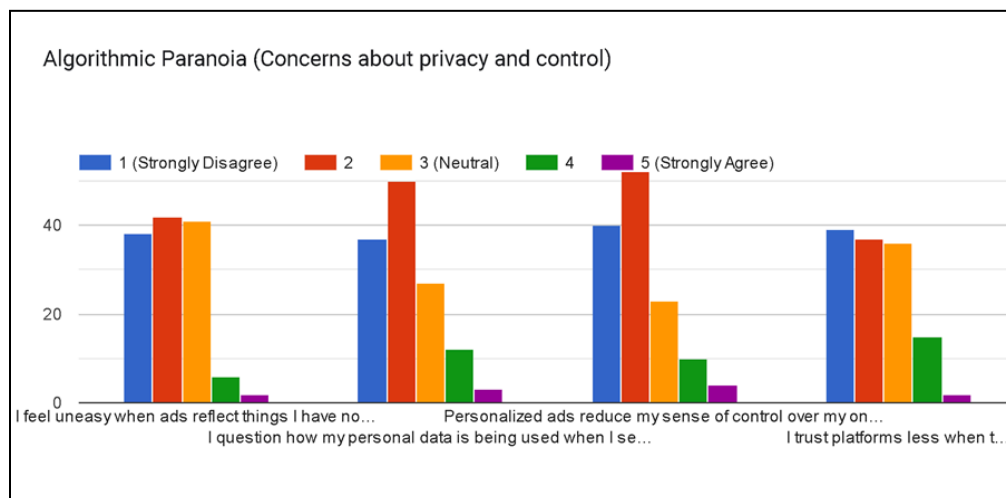
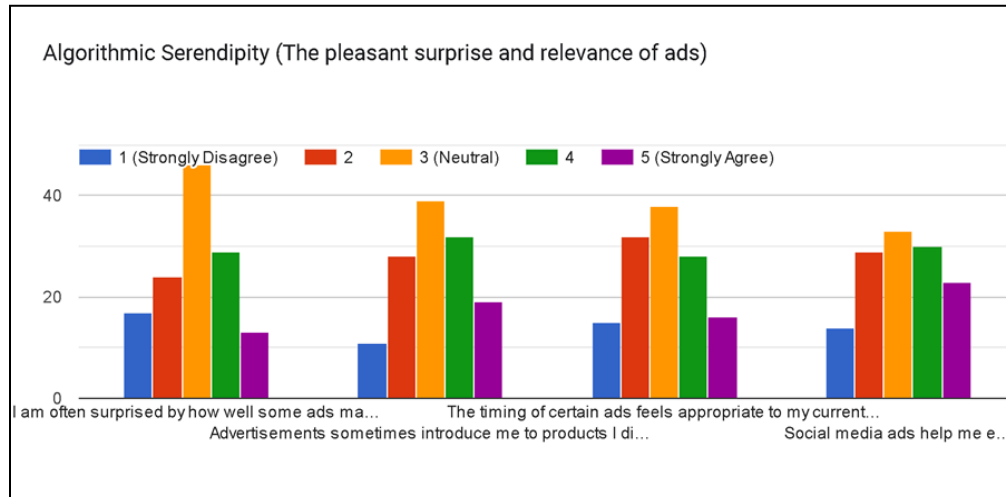
B. Sample Survey Items — Performative Sharing Scale

The following items constitute the Performative Sharing scale as administered in the survey instrument (Section 12 of the Google Form):

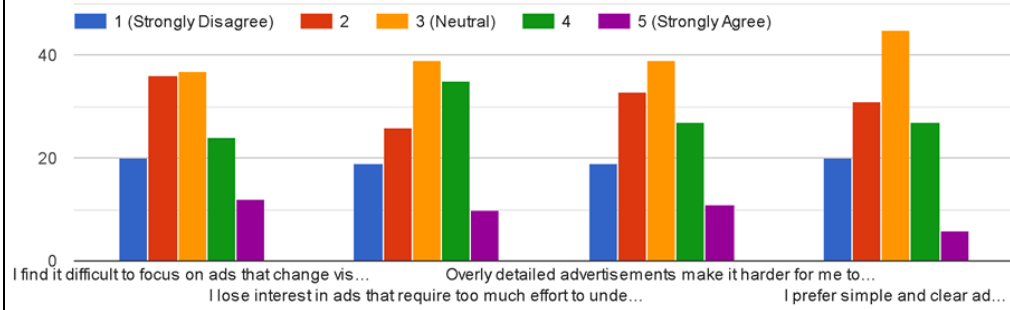
4. I am more likely to share advertisements that reflect values or causes I support.
5. I tend to share content that I believe will be appreciated by people in my social network.

6. Sharing certain advertisements helps me express what matters to me.
7. I am more likely to share ads that are currently popular or trending among my peers.

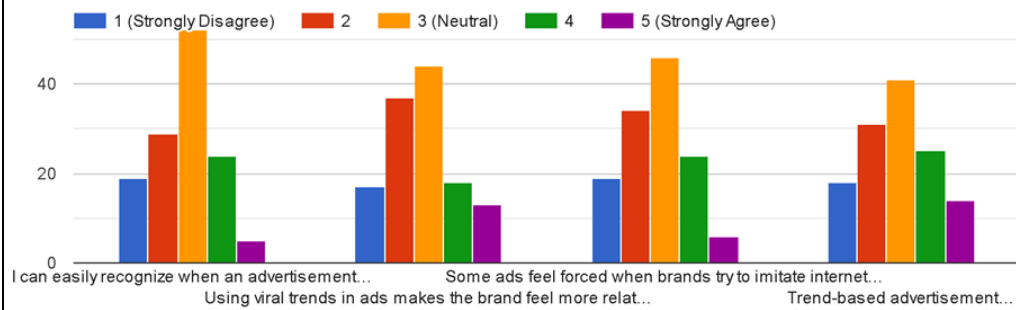
Response options: 1 = Strongly Disagree, 2 = Disagree, 3 = Neutral, 4 = Agree, 5 = Strongly Agree.



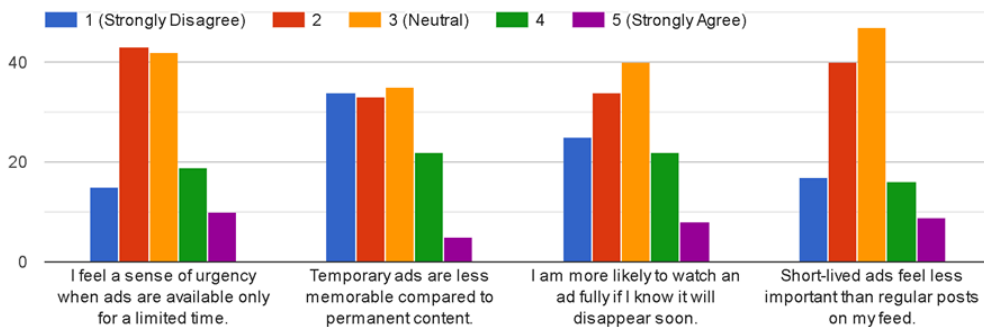
Information Fatigue / Cognitive Overload (Difficulty processing ad content)



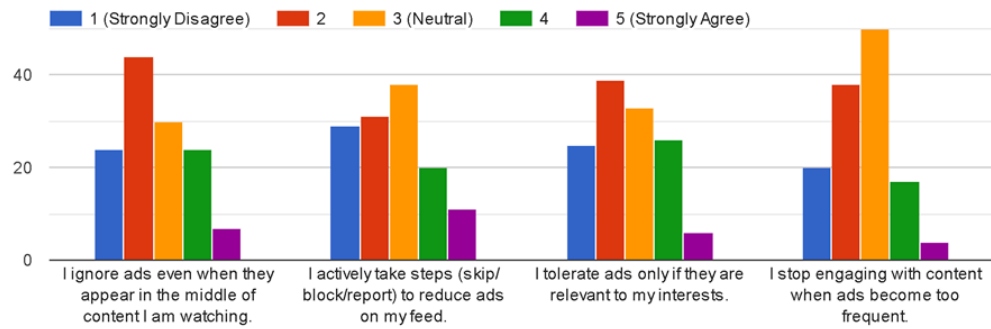
Meme-jacking (Use of viral trends and internet culture in ads)



Message Ephemerality (Ads that disappear or are only available for a limited time)



Ad-Avoidance Behaviour (Strategies to minimize exposure to ads)



Performative Sharing (Sharing ads to signal identity or gain peer approval)

